araben.study

Freemium Strategy and Content Report

Where araben stands today, what to keep free, what to charge for, and how to grow a sustainable Arabic-learning product for Bangla speakers.

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A Sources

Figures about araben's content come from its production database on 27 October 2026. Market figures are cited in Appendix A. Prices, targets and timelines are proposals to be validated, not forecasts.

1 Executive summary

araben.study already has something most paid apps lack: a deep, well-structured body of Arabic content written for Bangla speakers — 906 words with their own pages, 19 surahs word by word, 12 real-life dialogues, a 13-part grammar guide, the alphabet, word roots, and Arabic words hidden in everyday Bangla — plus an admin panel to grow it. What it does not yet have is anything that turns a visitor into a returning learner: no accounts, no progress, no practice loop, and no way to pay.

> **The recommendation in one line: free to learn, paid to master.** Keep every page of reading content free — it is araben's search engine, its reputation and its funnel — and charge for the things that make learning faster and stick: audio, video, practice, progress, offline access and credentials.

Key recommendations

1. **Never paywall the Qur'an content.** Word-by-word surahs stay free for everyone. It builds trust with the core audience and is the strongest search magnet on the site. Monetise the practice tools around it, not the meanings.
2. **Lead with the Gulf worker.** In 2025 about 1.13 million Bangladeshis went abroad for work, roughly 750,000 of them to Saudi Arabia. Practical, job-ready Arabic in Bangla is a clear, measurable need — and the existing scenario dialogues (taxi, hotel, immigration, pharmacy, phone plans) already point there.
3. **Make video and audio the premium core.** Two of twelve scenarios have video today and no audio is generated yet. Finishing both is the fastest way to a product worth paying for — and short clips double as marketing.
4. **Price for Bangladesh, collect through bKash.** Small monthly and discounted annual plans in taka, paid with bKash and Nagad (bKash alone has about 82 million customers), plus a one-time pre-departure pack.
5. **Build the foundations first:** learner accounts, progress tracking, analytics, entitlements and protected media. Without them, nothing can be gated or measured.
6. **Grow through partners as well as search:** recruiting agencies, training centres, madrasas and coaching centres buying access in bulk.

3–5%
Free-to-paid target. Education apps' median is about 3.1%; Duolingo converts about 9% of monthly users.

90 days
To a soft launch of premium, starting with accounts and analytics.

0 ads
Recommended: no ads on a learning site built on religious and personal trust.

2 Current platform and content inventory

Content

Section	What is there today	Size
Alphabet	All 28 letters, each with its fatha, kasra and damma forms and Bangla sound notes; a page per letter.	28 letters
Grammar	A 13-part bilingual guide, from sentence types and verbs to worked examples, common mistakes and a reference.	13 parts
Basics	Core vocabulary in 10 categories (pronouns, greetings, verbs, numbers…) and 3 warm-up dialogues.	138 entries 25 turns
Scenarios	12 real-life dialogues (restaurant, taxi, hotel, immigration, pharmacy, phone plans…), each in Arabic, transliteration, English and Bangla.	109 turns
Scenario videos	Uploadable from the admin; several per scenario supported. Restaurant and taxi have one video each.	2 of 12
Surahs	19 short surahs mapped word by word to English and Bangla, each word linked to its own study page.	526 words
Roots	36 three-letter roots: 20 with full word families, 16 at a glance.	119 family words
Hidden in Bangla	Arabic words living in everyday Bangla, in 7 categories, plus lists of Persian look-alikes, mixed words and English words of Arabic origin.	180 + 41
Word index and search	A page per word with where it appears, its root and related words; instant search in all four scripts.	906 pages
Trace game	Learners trace Arabic words stroke by stroke, letter by letter, on touch or mouse; managed in the admin.	21 words

Platform

Capability	Status	Notes
Bangla and English interface	**Built**	Every label switchable; content in Arabic, transliteration, English and Bangla.
Themes, mobile layout, SEO	**Built**	Three reading themes, sitemap, structured data, a page per word.
Content in a database + admin panel	**Built**	Secured sign-in; scenarios, surahs, hidden words, trace game and videos editable; audit log.
Audio pronunciation	**Partial**	Player and generation script exist (ElevenLabs); no audio generated yet.
Video	**Partial**	Upload and playback built; 2 of 12 scenarios covered; files on the server's disk.
Learner accounts and progress	**Missing**	Only admins can sign in. Nothing is remembered between visits.
Practice (quizzes, flashcards)	**Missing**	The trace game is the only interactive practice.
Payments and entitlements	**Missing**	No plans, no checkout, no gating.
Product analytics	**Missing**	No way yet to measure activation, retention or conversion.
Offline / installable app	**Missing**	Pages are light, but there is no offline mode or app.

3 Strengths, gaps and market context

Strengths

- Written for Bangla speakers from the ground up, not translated from English.
- Rare breadth: Qur'anic vocabulary, everyday dialogue, grammar and roots in one place, cross-linked.
- 906 indexable word pages — a long tail of search traffic at no extra cost.
- An admin panel, so content can grow without a developer.
- Distinctive hooks: "Arabic you already know" in Bangla, and the trace game.

Gaps

- No reason to return: no accounts, streaks, reviews or progress.
- Little to hear or watch: no audio yet, video on 2 scenarios.
- Reading-only; learners can't check themselves.
- Nothing to buy, and no data on who visits or why.
- Media on a single server's disk — fine now, fragile at scale.

Market context

1.13M
Bangladeshis who went abroad for work in 2025, up 11.5% on 2024 (BMET via Bangladesh Monitor).

~750K
of them to Saudi Arabia — a record for any single destination; Qatar and Kuwait are also in the top five.

82M
bKash customers, about 47 million active in the last 90 days (Bonik Barta).

Two things stand out. First, the Gulf labour market is overwhelmingly Arabic-speaking and Bangladesh is sending more workers there than ever; more than a third of 2025's Saudi-bound workers went through Saudi Arabia's Skill Verification Program, a sign that preparation before departure is becoming the norm. Second, the money rails exist: mobile financial services reach most Bangladeshi households, so small digital payments are realistic even for learners without cards.

On the religious side, interest in understanding the Qur'an rather than only reciting it is a durable, year-round motive that peaks around Ramadan. araben's word-by-word surahs serve exactly that need.

Benchmarks to keep expectations honest. Vendor data puts the median download-to-paid rate for education apps at about 3.1% (top 10%: 8.7%), and generic freemium apps at about 2.2%. Duolingo, the category leader, has about 9% of monthly users paying. A healthy target for araben's first year is 3–5% of active learners.

4 Who araben is for

Four groups, in order of recommended priority. Each needs a different promise, and the product should let each find its path from the home page.

Audience	What they need	What they will pay for
1. Gulf-bound and Gulf-based workers Pre-departure and first months abroad; mostly mobile, often low bandwidth.	Survival Arabic for real situations: work instructions, transport, shops, clinics, phone and bank errands, paperwork. Listening and speaking far more than reading.	Audio and video for every dialogue, job-specific packs, offline access, a completion certificate to show an employer or agency.
2. Qur'an comprehension learners Adults and teenagers who pray daily and want to understand.	Word-by-word meaning, roots, grammar that explains the verses, steady habit-building.	Recitation-style audio per word, memorisation and review tools, guided courses (e.g. Juz 'Amma), progress tracking.
3. Students and their teachers Madrasas, schools, coaching centres.	Structured lessons, practice, and a way for teachers to see progress.	Classroom licences, teacher dashboard, printable worksheets (B2B, often via the institution).
4. English-speaking diaspora The site already speaks English.	The same content, in English, often for children.	Higher price tolerance, card payments, family plans.

Why the Gulf worker first? The need is concrete and urgent (a job depends on it), the value is easy to show (a 30-second clip of a taxi ride), the audience is large and growing, and the content already leans that way. The Qur'an audience is larger in reach but less likely to pay for content it expects to be free — so treat it as the trust and traffic engine.

5 The freemium model: what is free, what is paid

Principles

- **Free must be genuinely useful** — a learner should be able to learn from araben without paying. That is what earns search rankings, shares and trust.
- **Paid saves time and adds accountability:** hearing, seeing, practising, tracking, downloading, certifying.
- **Every premium feature gets a free taste** — one full scenario with video and audio, a daily allowance of reviews — so learners know what they're buying.
- **Qur'anic meaning is never behind a paywall.**

Feature	Free	Premium
Alphabet, grammar, basics, roots, Hidden in Bangla	**All**	—
Surahs word by word	**All, always**	Word audio, review tools, guided courses
Scenario dialogues (text)	**All**	—
Word pages and search	**All**	—
Audio pronunciation	First scenario, Al-Fātiḥa, the alphabet	**Every word and dialogue line**
Scenario videos	Scenario 1 in full; a short preview of others	**All videos, offline viewing in the app**
Trace game	First 10 words	**Full library, letter practice**
Flashcards (spaced repetition)	20 reviews a day	**Unlimited, custom decks**
Quizzes per scenario and surah	First quiz of each section	**All quizzes, detailed results**
Progress and streaks	Basic (with a free account)	**Full history, goals, reminders**
Gulf work packs (new)	One sample lesson	**All packs**
Offline access	—	**Download packs for offline use**
Certificates	—	**Shareable completion certificates**
AI conversation practice (later)	A few turns a week	**Daily practice with feedback**

A free account (no payment) should unlock progress, streaks and the daily review allowance. Asking for sign-up in exchange for those — not for reading — grows the audience you can later convert.

6 Pricing and payments

Prices below are starting hypotheses for the Bangladeshi market, to be tested (two price points per plan in the first month is enough to learn a lot).

Plan	Proposed price	For whom	Notes
Monthly	৳149 / month	Trying it out	Low commitment; cancel any time.
Annual	৳999 / year	Committed learners	About 44% off monthly; the plan to promote.
Pre-departure pack	৳499 once	Gulf-bound workers	All scenarios and work packs with audio and video, offline, certificate; one year of access.
Family	৳1,499 / year	Households, diaspora	Up to 5 learners.
Institutions	৳150–250 per learner / year	Agencies, training centres, madrasas	Bulk codes, teacher dashboard; price by volume.

Payments

- **bKash and Nagad first**, through a local payment gateway that also takes cards, so diaspora learners can pay too. Confirm every payment through the gateway's server-side notification before unlocking anything.
- **Web checkout over app-store billing** where possible: app stores take a commission (15% on Google Play's reduced tier), and web payment keeps prices low.
- **Promotions that fit the calendar:** Ramadan (expected to begin in early February 2027), Eid, and the pre-departure peaks agencies report.
- **Receipts in Bangla**, a clear refund policy, and an easy cancel button — trust is the product.

7 Strategic approaches

1 · Free to learn, paid to master

Position araben as the most complete free Arabic resource in Bangla, with premium as the faster, guided path. Every free page carries a quiet, relevant upgrade prompt — the audio button on a word page, the video teaser on a scenario.

2 · Win one niche: the Gulf worker

Ship a "Pre-departure Arabic" track: the 12 scenarios plus job packs (construction, hospitality, driving, cleaning and domestic work, healthcare support), each with video, audio and a certificate. One audience, one promise, one price.

3 · The Qur'an as trust engine

Keep word-by-word surahs free and complete Juz 'Amma (37 surahs; 19 done). Have a qualified scholar review translations and credit them visibly. Trust earned here carries to every paid product.

4 · Video as product and marketing

Each scenario video is also a 30–60 second clip for Facebook, YouTube Shorts and TikTok, where Bangladeshi audiences spend their time — with a link back to the full scenario. Content produced once, used twice.

5 · Sell through partners (B2B2C)

Recruiting agencies, technical training centres and pre-departure orientation programmes need a ready-made Arabic module; madrasas and coaching centres need practice tools. Bulk codes reach hundreds of learners per deal.

6 · Mobile-first, low-bandwidth

Installable web app with offline packs, compressed and adaptive video, and audio-first lessons that work on a 3G connection and a basic Android phone.

7 · Habits, not just content

Accounts, streaks, spaced-repetition reviews and a daily 5-minute goal. Retention drives conversion: learners who come back are the ones who pay.

8 · Measure everything from day one

Instrument the funnel — visit, sign-up, first lesson, day-7 return, paywall view, purchase, renewal — and make pricing and paywall decisions from data, not guesses.

Search is araben's cheapest channel. With 906 word pages, 19 surah pages and 12 scenarios in two languages, every new piece of content is another way in. Keep reading content free and fast so it keeps ranking; put the conversion moment on the page, not in front of it.

8 Enhancement roadmap

Durations are indicative for a small team; each phase ends with something learners can use.

Phase 0 · Foundations

Weeks 1–6

- Learner accounts (phone number with one-time code, Google sign-in), separate from admin accounts.
- Progress tracking: lessons opened, words reviewed, trace words finished, streaks.
- Product analytics with a privacy-respecting tool; funnel dashboards.
- Entitlements: plans, expiry dates and which features each unlocks.
- Protected media: signed, expiring video and audio links; move files to object storage behind a CDN.

Phase 1 · Premium launch

Weeks 7–14

- Audio for every word and dialogue line (the generation pipeline exists; add a review step by a native speaker).
- Videos for all 12 scenarios.
- Flashcards with spaced repetition; quizzes for every scenario and surah.
- Payments (bKash, Nagad, cards), plans, paywall screens, receipts, cancellation.
- Soft launch to existing visitors; test two price points.

Phase 2 · Growth

Months 4–6

- Gulf work packs and the pre-departure track with certificates.
- Installable app with offline packs; daily reminders.
- Complete Juz 'Amma word by word; expand the trace game to letters and more words.
- Referral rewards; first institutional partners with bulk codes.

Phase 3 · Differentiation

Months 7–12

- AI conversation partner for the scenarios, with pronunciation feedback.
- Teacher dashboard and classroom licences.
- Grammar exercises tied to the 13-part guide; listening comprehension drills.
- Android app in the Play Store (wrapping the web app), if analytics show demand.

9 What it takes technically

araben's current stack — Next.js, MySQL with Prisma, NextAuth, and an admin panel — is a good base. These are the changes freemium needs, in order.

Area	Today	Needed
Accounts	Admin sign-in only (email and password).	Learner sign-in (phone code, Google) with its own table and roles, kept apart from admins.
Entitlements	None.	Plans, subscriptions and expiry; one server-side check every premium feature asks.
Gating	Content pages are pre-rendered and identical for everyone.	Keep reading pages pre-rendered and free; gate premium parts (audio, video, quizzes) through APIs that check the learner, so caching and search are unaffected.
Media	Videos on the server's disk, served to anyone with the link.	Object storage and a CDN; signed, expiring links for premium media; adaptive streaming for slow connections.
Payments	None.	Gateway integration with server-verified notifications, idempotent order handling, receipts and refunds.
Practice data	None.	Tables for progress, reviews (spaced repetition), quiz attempts and certificates.
Analytics	None.	Page and product events; funnel and retention dashboards.
Audio	Player and generation script; no files.	Generate, review and publish; track which words have approved audio.
Operations	Single server; manual backups.	Automated database and media backups, monitoring, error tracking.

> **One design rule worth fixing early:** content stays public and cacheable; access is decided per feature, not per page. That keeps the site fast and searchable while premium grows around it.

10 Metrics, revenue model and targets

Starting targets for the first year

Metric	Definition	Target
Activation	New visitors who finish a first lesson, scenario or trace word	35–40%
Account sign-up	Active visitors who create a free account	15%
Day-7 return	Learners who come back within a week	20%
Free-to-paid	Monthly active learners with a paid plan	3–5%
Monthly churn	Paying learners who don't renew	under 8%
Annual share	Paying learners on annual or one-time plans	over 50%

Illustrative revenue

Annual revenue = monthly active learners × share who pay × average revenue per payer. Assuming an average of ৳800 per paying learner per year (a mix of annual, monthly and one-time plans):

Monthly active learners	2% pay	3.1% pay (edu median)	5% pay
10,000	৳1.6 lakh	৳2.5 lakh	৳4 lakh
50,000	৳8 lakh	৳12.4 lakh	৳20 lakh
100,000	৳16 lakh	৳24.8 lakh	৳40 lakh

An illustration of how the levers combine, not a forecast. Before payment-gateway and store fees, and content and hosting costs (audio generation, video production, bandwidth). Institutional deals come on top.

> **The biggest lever is the number of active learners**, not the price. That is why the foundations (accounts, habits, analytics) come before the paywall, and why the free tier stays generous.

11 Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Low willingness to pay	Tiny entry price, annual and one-time options, value shown before the paywall; institutional sales where individuals can't pay.
Backlash at charging for religious content	Qur'anic meanings free forever, stated publicly; charge only for tools and media; consider a free-access programme for madrasa students.
Accuracy of Arabic and Bangla	Native-speaker and scholar review before publishing audio, video and translations; a "report a mistake" button.
Video sharing and piracy	Signed, expiring links and streaming rather than file downloads; accept some leakage — clips are marketing too.
Media cost and bandwidth	Compress and stream adaptively; CDN caching; audio-first lessons where video adds little.
Content production speed	The admin panel already lets non-developers publish; set a weekly content cadence and a simple production template for videos.
Data and privacy	Collect the minimum (phone or email, progress); clear privacy policy; secure payments handled by the gateway, never stored.
Single point of failure	Automated backups of database and media, a staging environment, and a second admin.
Overwriting admin edits	Already guarded: the content seed refuses to overwrite edits made in the admin unless forced.

12 The next 90 days

When	Do	Done when
Weeks 1–2	Add analytics; define the funnel; interview 10 Gulf-bound learners and 2 agencies about needs and prices.	A baseline: visitors, top pages, return rate; a list of must-have scenarios.
Weeks 3–6	Learner accounts, progress, streaks; entitlements model; move media to storage with signed links.	Learners can sign up and see their progress.
Weeks 5–9	Generate and review audio for all scenarios and Al-Fātiḥa; produce videos for the remaining 10 scenarios.	Every scenario has audio and video.
Weeks 7–10	Flashcards and scenario quizzes; payments with bKash and Nagad; paywall screens.	A learner can pay and unlock premium end to end.
Weeks 11–13	Soft launch with two price points; pilot with one training centre or agency; first social clips.	First paying learners; first conversion and retention numbers.

> **Decision for TechFiqh:** confirm the lead audience (Gulf workers, recommended) and the "Qur'an free forever" commitment. Everything in this plan follows from those two choices.

A Sources

- Bangladesh Monitor — "Around 1.13 million Bangladeshis fly abroad for jobs in 2025" (BMET data). bangladeshmonitor.com.bd
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- araben.study production database, 27 October 2026 — all content counts in section 2.

Market figures differ slightly between sources because of different data cut-off dates; the report uses the figures most sources agree on. Prices, targets, timelines and revenue illustrations are proposals for TechFiqh to validate.